

Philipp Hilbert. *Founding product manager for AI-native operational platforms.*

Positioning, ten years translating complex operational workflows into shipped software, now ready to do exactly that for an agentic AI platform from day one.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY SODA

Building an AI-native platform that automates complex operational workflows is precisely the problem space I have been working in for the past several years – not as an observer, but as the person writing user stories, unblocking engineers, and rolling features to production. The job description calls for someone who can operate like a mini-founder: running discovery, validating assumptions, and driving from idea to launch. That is the operating model I used at Rohde & Schwarz inside FCAS, at Emil Group while rebuilding a broken delivery organisation, and at the Federal Employment Agency while shipping a public data analytics platform. The specific signal that made this role stand out is the emphasis on agentic systems and workflow automation – I have designed multi-agent orchestration loops and worked hands-on with n8n and file-queue-based agent architectures, not just evaluated them from the outside. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, discovery synthesis and spec drafting
- **GPT**, edge-case generation and stakeholder writing
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted refactoring and review

- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
 - **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and landing pages
 - **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and alignment decks
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Django, AngularJS, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, Docker, GitOps, MicroStrategy, CGM API integration, Shopware, low-code insurance platform tooling.

§ SIDE PROJECT

DEV-AGENT FRAMEWORK & CRYPTO BACKTEST ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal infrastructure project building autonomous agent loops and a backtesting engine for crypto market strategies.

- Implements file-queue-based agent orchestration loops for autonomous multi-step execution tasks.
 - Uses a modular Python architecture separating strategy logic, data ingestion, and execution layers.
 - Draws on market microstructure analysis, liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital, and live DEX/CEX execution venues including Hyperliquid and Jupiter.
 - Demonstrates the same agentic workflow design and technical autonomy this role requires for production AI features.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SODA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every customer-facing call I can, read every support ticket and sales note available, and produce a first-pass workflow map of where users currently break — delivered to founders as a shareable artefact by end of week.

WEEK 2

Validate, then slice.

Take the three highest-friction workflow gaps, draft lean problem statements, and run two to three short customer interviews to pressure-test the framing before anything enters the backlog.

WEEK 3 +

Ship, measure, iterate.

Own the first prioritised initiative end-to-end: write acceptance criteria, stay close to engineering during build, define the success metric up front, and close the loop with customers after launch.

I COVER LETTER

Dear SODA team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role because the problem you are solving — automating complex operational workflows through an AI-native platform — is exactly what I have spent the past several years doing in production. Not advising on it, not roadmapping around it: writing the user stories, sitting beside engineers while they build, and rolling features to live environments.

At Rohde & Schwarz, inside the European defence programme FCAS, I owned an AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets. I delivered feature sets end-to-end — user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout via ArgoCD — and single-handedly unblocked an infrastructure issue that had been open for over a year, delivering in one week what engineers had not. At Emil Group, I inherited a broken B2B InsurTech delivery organisation, restructured a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops in what was still a prototype-stage environment. At the Federal Employment Agency I shipped a public labour market analytics platform, introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer — all simultaneously.

What I bring to an early-stage AI company is the combination of deep technical fluency and customer-facing discovery instinct that the job description asks for. I can read a Kubernetes

manifest, design an agentic workflow in n8n, and then sit in a customer interview the same afternoon to validate whether the workflow I just designed solves an actual pain or an assumed one. I use Claude, GPT, Lovable, and Cursor daily – not as productivity add-ons but as the primary surface through which I write specs, prototype interfaces, and generate edge cases. I have built my own multi-agent orchestration framework and a crypto backtesting engine as personal infrastructure projects, which is the clearest signal I can offer that this interest is structural rather than fashionable.

The role description explicitly says this is not a roadmap management position. That is reassuring rather than alarming to me. The work I find energising is precisely the upstream part: finding the real problem, designing the smallest test of a solution, getting that test in front of a user before engineering has written a line, and then driving the delivery once the bet is validated. I am also a native German speaker, which the listing flags as a nice-to-have, and I am already in Berlin.

I would welcome a conversation about the specific workflow problems your customers are bringing to you and how I can help turn those into product.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Founding Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable, shipped software. Background spans AI data platforms, public analytics infrastructure, B2B InsurTech SaaS, mobile healthcare, and quantum-secure encryption – always in environments where requirements were incomplete and delivery pressure was real. Fluent in AI-native workflows including LLM-assisted development, multi-agent orchestration, and rapid front-end prototyping. Equally comfortable running customer discovery interviews and sitting beside an engineer debugging a Kubernetes deployment. Six years of direct B2B SaaS experience; early-stage and founder-level context across multiple ventures.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Customer discovery and workflow pain mapping
- AI-native product execution and agentic workflow design
- End-to-end delivery ownership, user story to production rollout

- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, design, QA, and business stakeholders
- B2B SaaS backlog management and sprint discipline
- Rapid prototyping with low-code and LLM-assisted tooling
- Technical fluency across modern backend, data, and infrastructure stacks
- Founder-level pragmatism in ambiguous, fast-moving environments
- German native, English C2 – effective with both customer and investor audiences

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout via ArgoCD
- Unblocked an infrastructure-level OpenShift issue independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Improved data quality through filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Led a cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, replacing fragile manual pipelines
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades without service interruption
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation on a B2B platform reducing insurance time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline: split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units and introduced ownership and deputy concepts
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals (iOS and Android)
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity around legacy APIs and external database constraints

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

- **Co-Founder, CDO & Head of HR – Smart Soil Technologies (2021):** Intelligent self-regulation fertiliser and substrate solutions. Full establishment of digital tooling, financial and investment planning.
- **Product Owner – COVID-19 Data Platform, Bundesdruckerei (2021):** RKI projects DIM and DESH. Secure data structures and identity management.
- **Proxy Product Owner – AOK / ITSCare (2019–2020):** Migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies.
- **Project Lead – Enercon (2019):** Full IT modernisation of a specialist manufacturing site across software, infrastructure, and Office 365 rollout.
- **Product Owner – Qcrypt AG (2016–2018):** Quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware; also served as Deputy IT Security Officer.

- **Founder & CFO – Kvitt Payment Solutions (2013–2018):** Group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone; PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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